



**ROUTEUP CAREER GUIDANCE SERIES — VOLUME 7**

# **Your First 90 Days Abroad**

Housing, Money, Safety, and the Part-Time Reality

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## The Gap Between Landing and Living

The visa felt like the finish line. It was the starting line. The first 90 days decide your finances, your safety, your academic footing, and often your mental health for the whole course. Almost every serious problem we hear about begins in this window.

**Myth:** “I'll find a part-time job in my first month.”

**Reality:** Competition for student jobs is fierce, seasonal, and city-dependent. Many students search for months. If your budget dies without immediate work, your budget was wrong (Volume 3). Treat any early job as a bonus.

**Myth:** “Accommodation is easy to sort after landing.”

**Reality:** Arriving without secured short-term housing puts you at the mercy of whoever 'helps' first. Book verified temporary accommodation for at least the first 2–4 weeks, then search in person — never pay large deposits sight-unseen from India.

**Myth:** “Seniors from my community will look after me.”

**Reality:** Most will be kind. Some will not. Newly arrived students who owe personal favours to near-strangers are targets for exploitation — financial and worse. Cases of 'help' turning into demands are real and reported to us directly. Use official channels first: university accommodation offices, international student services, student associations.

## The 90-Day Checklist

### Before you fly

- ☐ Temporary housing booked (2–4 weeks, verified provider, refundable where possible)
- ☐ Bank plan: how you'll open a local account, and how family transfers money legally
- ☐ Health insurance active from day one; policy documents saved offline
- ☐ Copies of every document: cloud + physical + one set with family in India
- ☐ University orientation date registered; airport-to-housing route planned

### Week 1–2

- ☐ Local SIM, local bank account, university ID, transport card
- ☐ Register with the university's international student office (and city registration where required, e.g. Germany)
- ☐ Learn the emergency number and your campus security contact

### Week 3–12

- ☐ Permanent housing found IN PERSON; contract read before signing; deposit receipts kept
- ☐ Attendance protected — visa status depends on it; jobs come second
- ☐ Job search, done properly: CV adapted to local format, applications to named managers (Volume 8 method) — not desperate mass messages
- ☐ One weekly call home at a fixed time — it protects your family's peace and your own

What consultancies won't tell you: their service usually ends at the visa. The 'we'll arrange your part-time job / accommodation once you land' promise is the single most broken promise in this industry — the calls stop being answered once the commission is banked. Plan your landing as if no one will help you; then every genuine help is a bonus.

## Worksheet — My Landing Plan

☐ My first-night address and how I get there from the airport:

\_\_\_\_\_

☐ Money available for first 90 days (without any job):

\_\_\_\_\_

☐ My university's international student office contact:

\_\_\_\_\_

☐ Local emergency number + campus security number:

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☐ Fixed weekly call time with family: \_\_\_\_\_

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## When to Get Help

Everything in this volume you can act on yourself — that is deliberate. But the worksheet you just filled has answers only YOU could write, and validating those answers against real requirements, real budgets, and real immigration rules is where mistakes hide.

*Bring your completed landing plan to session with RouteUp. We will go through it line by line and tell you honestly — including if your plan is fine and you don't need us further.*

**Book your free session:** [www.routeup.co.in](http://www.routeup.co.in) · [hello@routeup.co.in](mailto:hello@routeup.co.in) ·

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